

Maria Silva

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LLB (2:1, UCL) and LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution (Merit, Queen Mary) graduate with hands-on experience supporting active disputes and litigation matters at a City law firm, alongside frontline legal advice work and in-house legal exposure. Experienced in preparing hearing bundles and court materials, drafting procedural documents, reviewing and organising evidence, managing case files and meeting competing deadlines. Strong organisational skills, close attention to detail and a practical, client-focused approach to legal work. Based in the Reading area and seeking a role within a supportive, professional environment offering scope for development.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules: international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis and legal research
- Dissertation on cross-jurisdictional development of data protection law (GDPR) — awarded Distinction (75%)

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included: Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize: top 20 of a 200-student cohort, with partial funding toward undergraduate degree

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended substantive sections of the memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted legal and factual research to support submissions
- Became the sole junior on the matter approaching a significant deadline — coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time delivery
- Maintained structured electronic case files; monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated external translations
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to that of a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking
- Prepared client notes and maintained matter records via iManage; managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead**July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Manages a varied caseload end to end: takes detailed client statements, establishes chronologies, identifies relevant legal and evidential issues across welfare, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, and maintains accurate confidential case records to deadline
- Researches complex legal points independently; assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria and identifies evidential gaps
- Translates procedural requirements and complex rules into clear, practical guidance for clients — including vulnerable individuals under pressure

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction to formal written advice, under qualified solicitor supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks from the client's data processing and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer obligations
- Liaised across sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries; communicated amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; electronic bundling; court filing portals; iManage; case management and time-recording systems; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; concise report and correspondence writing

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across competing matters